



JAMAICA CONSTABULARY FORCE

Criminal Investigation Branch Standard Operating Procedures on Criminal Investigation Process Flow

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CRIMINAL INVESTIGATION BRANCH

SOLVABILITY FACTORS

- Witnesses to the crime
- Knowledge of the suspect's name
- Knowledge of where the suspect can be located
- Description of suspect
- Identification of suspect
- Property with traceable, identifiable characteristics, marks or numbers
- Existence of a significant method of operation
- Presence of significant physical evidence
- Description of the suspect's vehicle
- Positive results from a crime scene evidence search
- Belief that crime may be solved with publicity and/or reasonable additional investigative effort
- Possibility and/or opportunity for anyone, other than the suspect, to have committed the crime

The Investigation Flow Chart

Introduction

This is intended to create a standard which is to be utilized as a best practice. The deficiency in the investigative process is often based on the method employed to carry out investigation. In many instances several steps in the process are inadvertently omitted. The Lack of a structured approach often adversely impacts the quality and speed at which evidence is obtained and information analysed.

In many instances the legal ramification is substituted for expedience, therefore cases which had potential are invariably dismissed in the court. The investigation flowchart is therefore intended to direct investigators as to the sequence of activities that are to be initiated when advancing an investigation.

First Responder

The first responder must be cognizant that the crime scene is the beginning point of a successful or unsuccessful investigation.

Duties of a First Responder

- To maintain the link that connects the suspect to the victim and the crime scene (Crime Scene Preservation).
- Identify and locate crime scene
- Inform control as to the nature of the crime
- Identify victims, if any (check for signs of life)
- To ensure safety of victim.
- To secure established crime scene perimeters.
- Identify possible suspect
- Apprehend suspect/s if possible
- To preserve and collect relevant information and any physical evidence that will make a connection between all parties involved.
- Identify any possible witness
- To preliminary interview victims, onlookers and witnesses to extract information pertinent to the crime and suspect / offenders.

- Manage the crime scene ie to avoid contamination making copious record of everyone who enters the crime scene
- Brief investigating officer on his arrival

Duties of a First Responder (continued)

- To report all events that took place to the Investigating Officer to include any adjustments or alternation made to the crime scene.
- Secure common approach path way
- To be in possession of a register so as to document all occurrences at the crime scene
- To ensure proper crowd control
- To enforce proper traffic management where necessary
- To provide a detailed report of the incident

“Lack of accurate information, omissions, negligence, under or overemphasis in information can severely damage the investigation”

The Forensics Crime Scene Investigator

- Set and understanding of what the investigation will entail and construct a plan of action for locating and gathering evidence.
- Ensure that all physical evidence is located and collected in a proper manner.
- Secure crime scene from contamination
- Go over what he/she think took place and why
- Record all pertinent information

Review Team

To look into the case to identify solvability factors and where these factors are absent or limited to steer investigation into the direction of obtaining additional information through interviews or re-interview to strengthen the case, exploiting all available technology.

Legal Team

Provide guidance in areas of laws and outline legal implications for the case under investigation in order to solidify the case presentation based on precedence etal.

Case Conference / Prosecution review

DPP or Clerk of the Court for legal advice and direction

Cold Case

In the absence of a successful investigation, cases should be sent to cold case review to be examined and additional work done which may include re interviewing witnesses.

Background and Enquiries Team

This team which is established at all divisional HQ, will capitalize on opportunities that exist within the first 24 hours of any investigation. This includes the identification of solvability factors as well as coordinating the exploitation of technology to obtain scientific evidence.

Crime Officers

The Crime Officer is responsible to marshal the investigative process outline in the flow chart and, provide guidance where needed ensuring task assignment and execution.

Flow Chart

